Yang Berusaha Professor Ir Dr Rajkumar Durairaj
UCSI University deputy vice-chancellor of Academic and Student Affairs

Yang Berusaha Distinguished Professor Dr Phang Siew Moi
UCSI University deputy vice-chancellor of Research and Postgraduate Studies

Yang Berusaha Associate Professor EUR ING Ir Ts Dr Ang Chun Kit UCSI University's Centre for Academic Quality Assurance associate deputy vice-chancellor

Yang Berusaha Ts Khalid Abdullah Abu Bakar

UCSI University Group Education registrar and Group Human Resource senior director

Yang Berusaha Mr Sheikh Fahmy Sheikh Mohamed

UCSI Group Business Development vice-president

Yang Berusaha Mr Wajeeh Hassan

UCSI University Student Council president

Members of the UCSI University Council, Senate and top management

Esteemed Faculty deans, directors, heads of School and heads of Department

Distinguished guests, esteemed colleagues

Parents and students

Ladies and gentlemen

Good morning students!

Welcome to UCSI University, a place where you will learn, grow and over the next few years, come to know as your second home.

Before I go further, let me congratulate all of you. You worked hard to get here and today marks the start of an exciting new chapter in your life.

University is not just another academic step. It is a world of opportunities, friendships and experiences waiting to unfold. Whether you're coming from nearby towns or from across the globe, we're truly honoured that you've chosen UCSI as your academic home.

Since our founding in 1986, we have grown not only in size, but also in spirit. We are a university built on integrity, inclusivity and excellence. With over 15,000 students from more than 120 nations, our campus is a vibrant melting pot of cultures, beliefs and perspectives.

Here, you will meet people from different walks of life, different backgrounds. Embrace these differences. Learn from each other. Respect one another. These interactions will enrich your journey just as much as your academic learning will.

Throughout your time here, you will be challenged, but you will also be supported. Our faculty members are more than just lecturers. They are researchers, mentors and partners in your academic journey. And as you begin, it is important for you to know the people who will guide and inspire you along the way.

To our deans and directors, please rise as you are introduced.

We have Prof Dr Keoy Kay Hooi, dean of Graduate Business School; Assoc Prof Ts Dr Crystale Lim Siew Ying, dean of the Faculty of Applied Sciences; Asst Prof Dr Loh Yue Fang, dean of the Faculty of Business and Management.

Next, we have Prof EUR ING. Ir Ts Dr Lim Wei Hong, dean of the Faculty of Engineering, Technology and Built Environment; Assoc Prof Dr Hanafi Hamzah, dean of the Faculty of Hospitality and Tourism Management and Prof Dr Rogayah Razak, dean of the Faculty of Social Sciences and Liberal Arts.

We are also joined by Prof Ts Dr Khairul Aidil Azlin, director of De Institute of Creative Arts and Design; Prof Ts Dr Shayla Islam, director of the Institute of Computer Science and Digital Innovation and Senior Prof Dr P'ng Tean Hwa, director of the Institute of Music. Alongside them is Prof Dr Zuraidah Mohd Don, director of the Institute of Languages.

We also welcome Mr Por Choo Shiuan, deputy dean of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences; Prof Ts Dr Tan Wee Hoe, deputy dean of the International Institute of Science Diplomacy and Sustainability and Prof Ir Ts Dr Show Pau Loke, director of the Centre of Excellence for Research, Value Innovation and Entrepreneurship.

And last but not least, Asst Prof Sudesh Balasubramaniam, director of the Academic Management Office and Mr Kumaresh Kumar, director of Student Affairs and Services.

From this remarkable team, you will be learning from the best of the best. 28 of our academics are recognised as Fellows of Academy of Sciences Malaysia and 15 of our professors have been named among the world's top 2% scientists by Stanford University.

These are not just brilliant minds. These are passionate educators who want to see you grow. So, don't hesitate to approach them. Use your time here to explore, question and discover. Be curious, be bold and don't be afraid to fail. Take full advantage of our library, state-of-the art labs and facilities.

We also have a Student Development and Counselling Department that is committed to supporting you through academic pressure, personal

struggles or anything in between. Our counsellors are here for you. So please don't hesitate to reach out. Remember, seeking support is a strength, not a sign of weakness.

At UCSI, you are joining a community where changemakers are shaped. Four of our alumni have made the Forbes 30 Under 30 Asia list for empowering refugees through social entrepreneurship and for breaking glass ceilings in their fields. Three more are Prestige 40 Under 40 laureates for their contributions to Malaysia's creative industry. Among them is Aina Abdul, Malaysia's Queen of Pop, who hails from our very own Institute of Music. We also celebrate Cynthia Ng, a Mass Communication graduate who is now one of Malaysia's most recognisable news anchors and the face of Astro Awani.

We are equally proud of our current students. Nine of them, along with a staff member, represented Malaysia at the recent SEA games, bringing home an impressive haul of three gold, two silver and two bronze medals.

Yow Mei Yee clinched gold in Taekwando, while Steve Khiew Hoe Yean made history as the only Malaysian to achieve a three-peat in the 200m men's freestyle, in addition to winning gold in the 400m freestyle. Both Hoe Yean and Bertrand Rhodict Lises went on to represent Malaysia at the Paris 2024 Olympic Games. Their journeys show that with hard work and heart, big dreams really can come true.

Our top performing students are also selected annually to pursue high impact research at leading universities, including Harvard University, Imperial College London, the University of Chicago, Tsinghua University, the University of Queensland and the University of British Columbia.

All of these achievers started their journeys right here. They walked these same halls, received the same education and now look at where they are. If they can do it, so can you. Just remember to go the extra mile and never be afraid to keep pushing forward. This is the place to explore your strengths and realise your potential.

And you'll be doing it at one of the best. UCSI is classified in the world's top 1%, placed 269th in the QS World University Rankings 2026. We're also ranked 30th in the QS Asia University Rankings 2026 and 8th in Southeast Asia.

Your chosen programme is also backed by strength. In the QS World University Rankings by Subject 2025, we've made significant progress. UCSI is ranked 78th for Arts and Humanities, 132nd for Social Sciences and Management and 223rd for Engineering and Technology.

The university also made the global top 500 in eight subjects, a 60% improvement from last year. These results speak for themselves. You're joining a university that is rising rapidly and making an impact across multiple fields. The opportunities to shine are aplenty, so aim high and keep striving for excellence.

At UCSI, we prepare you for more than exams. With over 4,800 industry partners, we connect you to real-world opportunities. Our strong industry ties are a key reason why UCSI achieved a 100% employability score in the Malaysian Higher Education Ministry's Graduate Employability survey. So, when you graduate, you won't just have a degree, you'll have the experience and connections to get ahead in your career.

One example of how we connect learning to real-world impact is in the field of cybersecurity.

Every year, we host a tertiary level cybersecurity hackathon in collaboration with our industry partners. Last year, we worked closely with X3 Security, who conducted workshops, designed challenges and executed the competition with excellence, creating a truly world-class experience for all participants.

Cybersecurity plays a vital role in safeguarding our nation's digital infrastructure. In 2025 alone, Malaysia recorded over 5,700 cybersecurity incidents, according to Cyber999. But we are moving forward. With the passing of the Cybersecurity Act 2024, the nation is paving the way for 12,000 new jobs, contributing to Malaysia's goal of building a workforce of 25,000 cyber defenders.

By participating in our annual hackathon, students put their coding, cybersecurity and critical thinking skills to the test, preparing themselves to become the cybersecurity experts our nation needs. And I am proud that UCSI University continues to lead the way in nurturing the next generation of cybersecurity professionals.

UCSI has also developed a partnership with the Malaysia Board of Technologists (MBOT), enabling graduates to attain membership status within the professional body. Those emerging from MBOT-accredited programmes will be eligible for automatic registration as Graduate Technologists or Graduate Technicians. This collaboration ensures that

UCSI's academic programmes meet industry-aligned competencies and the technological needs of the future.

These are the kinds of opportunities waiting for you at UCSI. Opportunities that challenge you, grow you and prepare you for what lies ahead.

Beyond the classroom, make the most of university life. Step out of your comfort zone. Get involved. Join clubs and societies. Participate in community service projects that make a real difference. These experiences will not only build your confidence but also create friendships that could last a lifetime.

But with that freedom and opportunity comes responsibility. You are now part of a proud institution and we expect you to uphold the values that define us. This means acting with honesty, treating others with respect and adhering to the academic and behavioural standards of the University.

Above all, I believe you'll make the most out your time here. University is your chance to understand who you are, what excites you and what you're truly passionate about. This is your journey, and we are honoured to walk it with you.

Once again, welcome to UCSI. I wish you all a fulfilling and successful experience ahead. Let's make these years count!

Thank you.